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CUET UG

History

Mahatma Gandhi and National Movements

Theme 11 · Civil Disobedience and Beyond · CUET UG 2027 Complete Mastery

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Syllabus Alignment & Chapter Architecture

Sub-Topic Domain	Official NTA CUET UG Unit XI Syllabus Scope	High-Frequency Cognitive Skills Tested
South Africa & Indian Entry	Return to India (Jan 1915); G.K. Gokhale as mentor; Banaras Hindu University (BHU) speech (Feb 1916); Champaran Satyagraha (1917, **tinkathia** indigo); Ahmedabad Mill Strike (1918, 35% wage hike); Kheda Satyagraha (1918, revenue remission).	Analyzing ideological evolution; ordering early satyagraha chronologies; evaluating Gandhi's critique of elite nationalism.
Rowlatt, Khilafat & NCM	Rowlatt Act (1919) and nationwide hartal (6 April); Jallianwala Bagh massacre (13 April 1919); Khilafat Movement (Ali brothers); Non-Cooperation Movement (1920–1922); boycott program; **Chauri Chaura** (4 Feb 1922); Broomfield trial.	Deconstructing mass mobilization strategies; analyzing inter-communal political coalitions; identifying ethical imperatives behind withdrawal.
Constructive Work & Purna Swaraj	Swarajists (C.R. Das, Motilal Nehru) vs No-Changers; Simon Commission boycott (1928); death of Lala Lajpat Rai; Nehru Report (1928); Lahore Congress (Dec 1929); **Purna Swaraj** pledge; First Independence Day (26 Jan 1930).	Evaluating internal ideological divides; tracing constitutional formulations; analyzing symbolic declarations of sovereignty.
Civil Disobedience & Salt March	Salt March to Dandi (12 March – 6 April 1930; 240 miles, 78 ashramites); salt monopoly symbolism; global press coverage (Webb Miller, **Time** magazine); First RTC (1930 boycott); Gandhi-Irwin Pact (March 1931); Second RTC (1931); Poona Pact (1932).	Analyzing commodity symbolism; examining diplomatic bargaining; evaluating caste franchise debates and separate electorates.
Quit India & Mass Upsurge	World War II outbreak; Cripps Mission (1942); Quit India resolution at Bombay (8 Aug 1942); **"Do or Die"**; Operation Zero Hour; parallel governments (**Prati Sarkar** at Satara, Ballia, Tamluk); underground radio (Usha Mehta, Lohia).	Ordering wartime political crises; evaluating spontaneous subaltern rebellions; analyzing underground revolutionary networks.
Partition, Freedom & Martyrdom	Cabinet Mission (1946); Direct Action Day (16 Aug 1946); Gandhi's peace missions in Noakhali and Calcutta; "One-Man Boundary Force"; 15 August 1947 fast; assassination by Nathuram Godse (30 Jan 1948); primary sources (letters, police reports).	Analyzing decolonization trajectories; evaluating communal reconciliation methods; deconstructing official intelligence archives.

CUET HIGH-SCORING INSIGHT & KEY COGNITIVE TRAPS

Theme 11 is the most heavily tested modern history chapter in CUET UG. Focus on these recurrent cognitive distinctions:

1. **Early Satyagraha Chronology:**
   - **Champaran (1917):** Against indigo **tinkathia** system in Bihar; Gandhi's first civil disobedience.

- **Ahmedabad (Feb–Mar 1918):** Dispute over plague bonus for textile workers; Gandhi's first hunger strike; won 35% wage increase.
- **Kheda (Mar–Jun 1918):** Failure of crops; peasants demanded revenue suspension; Gandhi's first non-cooperation.

2. **The Three Round Table Conferences (London):**
   - **First RTC (1930):** Boycotted by Congress.
   - **Second RTC (1931):** Attended by Mahatma Gandhi as the **sole representative** of the Indian National Congress following the Gandhi-Irwin Pact.
   - **Third RTC (1932):** Boycotted by Congress; resulted in Government of India Act 1935.
3. **Poona Pact (September 1932):**
   - Gandhi opposed British Prime Minister Ramsay MacDonald's **Communal Award** creating separate electorates for Depressed Classes.
   - Gandhi went on a fast unto death in Yerwada Jail; pact signed with Dr. B.R. Ambedkar abandoned separate electorates in favor of **reserved seats** in joint electorates.
4. **Quit India Movement Parallel Governments** (Prati Sarkar)**:**
   - **Ballia (UP):** Under Chittu Pandey (first parallel government).
   - **Tamluk (Midnapore, Bengal): Jatiya Sarkar** with Vidyut Vahini women's volunteer corps.
   - **Satara (Maharashtra): Prati Sarkar** under Nana Patil and Y.B. Chavan.

1. The South African Crucible and Return to India (1915–1918)

Mahatma Gandhi's leadership of the Indian national struggle was shaped by two decades of experimental activism in South Africa, which historian Chandran Devanesan famously characterized as "the making of the Mahatma":

The South African Laboratory (1893–1914)

In South Africa, Gandhi went as a legal counsel for a Gujarati merchant firm, but stayed for twenty-one years fighting racial discrimination (**apartheid**):

- **Satyagraha Formulation:** He forged the philosophical doctrine of **Satyagraha** (truth-force or soul-force) based on unwavering non-violence (**ahimsa**), civil disobedience, and voluntary suffering.
- **Communal Harmony:** He welded together a diverse diaspora of Indians—Hindus, Muslims, Parsis, Christians, upper-caste merchants, and low-caste Tamil indentured laborers.
- **Intellectual Influences:** Gandhi's economic and spiritual worldview was profoundly transformed by three thinkers:
  - **John Ruskin's Unto This Last:** Translated into Gujarati as **Sarvodaya** ("Universal Uplift"), inspiring the establishment of the **Phoenix Settlement** (1904) near Durban and the **Tolstoy Farm** (1910) near Johannesburg, where all community members engaged in equal manual labor.
  - **Leo Tolstoy's The Kingdom of God Is Within You:** Cultivating radical Christian anarchism and non-violent resistance.
  - **Henry David Thoreau's Essay on Civil Disobedience:** Inspiring the refusal to obey unjust, immoral laws.

Return to India and the BHU Speech (1915–1916)

In **January 1915**, Gandhi returned permanently to India:

- **Gokhale's Mentorship:** On the advice of his political mentor, **Gopal Krishna Gokhale**, Gandhi spent his first year traveling by third-class railway across the subcontinent to observe the realities of colonial exploitation firsthand.
- **The BHU Speech (February 1916):** Gandhi's first major public appearance occurred at the opening ceremony of the **Banaras Hindu University (BHU)** in February 1916. In a speech that shocked the assembled elite, Gandhi fiercely rebuked the diamond-studded princes and wealthy lawyers:
  - **"There is no salvation for India unless you strip yourselves of this jewelry and hold it in trust for your countrymen in India."**
  - He declared that nationalism could have no real meaning as long as the vast mass of impoverished peasantry remained voiceless and exploited.

The Triad of Local Satyagrahas (1917–1918)

Gandhi established his moral authority through three localized agrarian and labor interventions:

1. **Champaran Satyagraha (1917, Bihar):** Persuaded by an unlettered indigo cultivator, **Raj Kumar Shukla**, Gandhi traveled to Champaran to investigate the oppressive **tinkathia** system (which legally forced peasants to cultivate indigo on 3/20th of their holdings). Despite colonial orders to leave, Gandhi refused, conducted extensive public inquiries, and compelled the government to abolish tinkathia and refund 25% of illegal extractions.
2. **Ahmedabad Mill Strike (February–March 1918, Gujarat):** Intervening in a wage dispute between textile mill owners and workers over the withdrawal of the "plague bonus", Gandhi undertook his **first fast unto death**. Supported by **Anasuya Sarabhai**, he secured an arbitration award granting workers a **35 percent wage increase**.
3. **Kheda Satyagraha (March–June 1918, Gujarat):** When severe drought caused crops to fail below one-fourth of normal yield, peasants were legally entitled to revenue remission under the Land Revenue Code. When colonial authorities refused, Gandhi organized peasants to withhold taxes peacefully. Guided by **Vallabhbhai Patel**, the government eventually issued secret orders exempting poor peasants who could not pay.

2. The Pan-Indian Surge: Rowlatt, Jallianwala Bagh & Khilafat

The conclusion of World War I brought severe economic distress, inflation, and coercive wartime measures that set the stage for a nationwide confrontation:

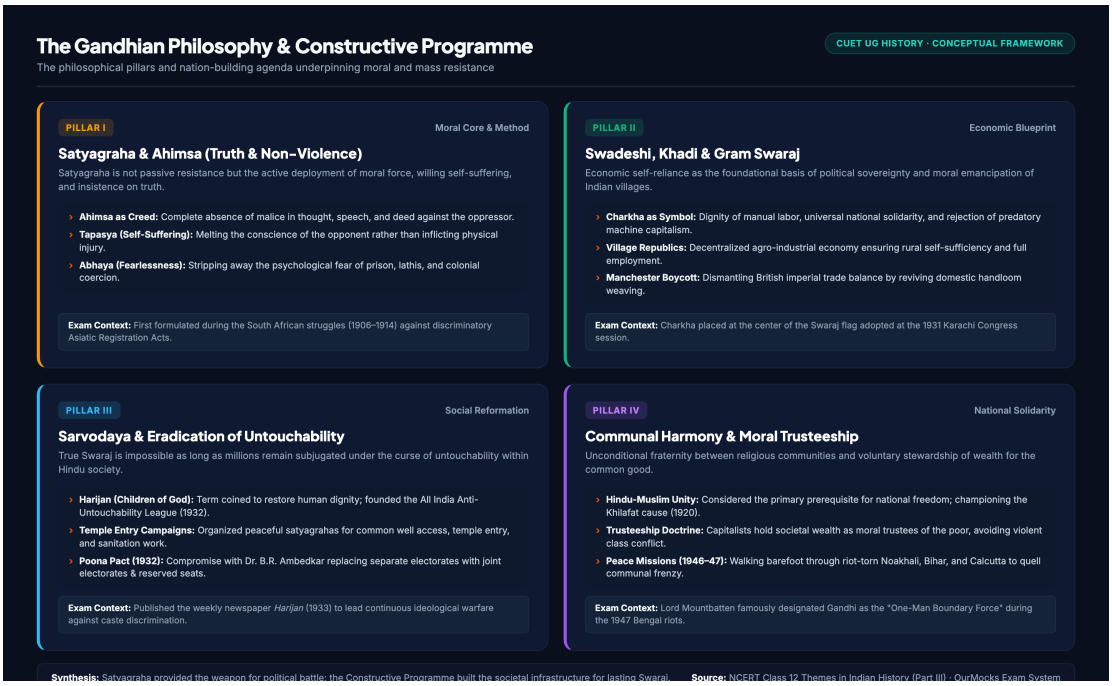


Figure 1: Figure 1 — The Strategic Quadrant of Gandhian Satyagraha: Harmonizing moral philosophy, non-violent mass defiance, constructive rural work, and institutional negotiation.

The Rowlatt Act and Nationwide Satyagraha (1919)

In March 1919, the imperial government passed the **Anarchical and Revolutionary Crimes Act** (popularly known as the **Rowlatt Act**), based on the recommendations of Sir Sidney Rowlatt:

- **Coercive Provisions:** The act authorized the detention of any political suspect for up to two years without warrant, trial, or legal representation (**"No Dalil, No Vakil, No Appeal"**).
- **The Nationwide Hartal (6 April 1919):** Gandhi organized the **Rowlatt Satyagraha Sabha**, calling for a nationwide general strike (**hartal**) on **6 April 1919**. Business closed across the country, transforming anti-colonial protest from an elite constitutional debate into a truly pan-Indian popular movement.

The Jallianwala Bagh Massacre (13 April 1919)

The movement encountered savage imperial counter-violence in Punjab:

- **The Gathering:** On **13 April 1919** (the festival of Baisakhi), a peaceful crowd of thousands gathered in the enclosed compound of **Jallianwala Bagh** in Amritsar to celebrate the harvest festival and protest the arrest of local leaders Dr. Saifuddin Kitchlew and Dr. Satyapal.
- **The Slaughter:** Brigadier-General **Reginald Dyer** blocked the sole narrow exit with troops and, without issuing any warning, ordered his soldiers to fire continuously into the trapped crowd until ammunition was exhausted. Hundreds of men, women, and children were butchered.
- **Renunciation of Honours:** In overwhelming anguish and moral outrage, **Rabindranath Tagore** renounced his British **Knighthood**, declaring that the time had come when badges of honor made shame conspicuous.

The Khilafat Alliance (1919–1920)

Simultaneously, Indian Muslims were deeply agitated over the harsh treatment meted out to the Ottoman Caliph (Khalifa) by victorious European powers following the dismemberment of the Ottoman Empire in the Treaty of Sevres:

- **The Ali Brothers: Muhammad Ali** and **Shaukat Ali** founded the **All India Khilafat Committee**.

- **Strategic Coalition:** Gandhi recognized a historic opportunity to forge an unbreakable alliance between Hindus and Muslims: **"An opportunity of uniting Hindus and Mohammedans as would not arise in a hundred years."** He persuaded the Indian National Congress to endorse the Khilafat cause and launch Non-Cooperation.

3. The Non-Cooperation Movement and Its Aftermath (1920–1922)

The Non-Cooperation Movement was officially sanctioned at the special Calcutta Congress session (September 1920) and ratified at Nagpur (December 1920):

The Program of Non-Violent Non-Cooperation

Gandhi argued that the British Empire existed only because Indians cooperated with it; if Indians refused to cooperate, British rule would collapse within a year (**"Swaraj in one year"**):

- **Boycott Program:** Surrender of imperial titles and honorary offices (Gandhi returned his **Kaiser-i-Hind** gold medal); boycott of government law courts, schools, colleges, and legislative councils; boycott of foreign cloth and British manufactured commodities.
- **Constructive Program:** Promotion of hand-spun and hand-woven **khadi**, universal popularization of the **charkha** (spinning wheel), establishment of national educational institutions (**Kashi Vidyapeeth**, **Gujarat Vidyapith**, **Jamia Millia Islamia**), promotion of Hindu-Muslim unity, and abolition of the curse of untouchability.

Subaltern Upsurge and Varied Understandings of Swaraj

As the movement spread across India, ordinary subaltern peasants and workers interpreted "Swaraj" through their own local needs and cultural idioms:

- **Peasant Resistance in Awadh:** Led by **Baba Ramchandra**, Awadh peasants refused to pay illegal cesses (**abwabs**) and demanded security of tenure against oppressive taluqdars.
- **Tribal Forest Satyagrahas:** In the Gudem Hills of Andhra Pradesh, tribal leader **Alluri Sitarama Raju** led an armed guerrilla struggle against oppressive colonial forest laws, claiming inspiration from Gandhi while defending tribal rights to shifting cultivation.
- **Labor Strikes:** In Assam, tea garden laborers struck work, marched along railway tracks, and demanded living wages, singing that Gandhi Maharaj had freed them from European tea planters.

Chauri Chaura and the Historic Trial (1922)

Just as the movement was approaching its climax, it erupted into violence:

- **The Incident (4 February 1922):** At **Chauri Chaura** in the Gorakhpur district of Uttar Pradesh, a peaceful procession of peasants was fired upon by the police. An enraged mob retaliated by locking the police station and setting it on fire, killing **22 policemen**.
- **The Abrupt Withdrawal:** Deeply committed to absolute non-violence, Gandhi declared that the nation was not yet spiritually disciplined for true Satyagraha. Overriding fierce protests from senior colleagues (Subhas Chandra Bose, Jawaharlal Nehru, and C.R. Das), Gandhi unilaterally called off the movement through the **Bardoli Resolution** on **12 February 1922**.
- **The Broomfield Trial (March 1922):** Gandhi was arrested in March 1922 and tried before British Judge **C.N. Broomfield** on charges of sedition. In a historic speech, Gandhi declared: **"I am here, therefore, to invite and cheerfully submit to the highest penalty that can be inflicted upon me for what in law is a deliberate crime, and what appears to me to be the highest duty of a citizen."** Judge Broomfield sentenced him to six years' imprisonment, remarking on Gandhi's noble character.

4. Constructive Work, Simon Commission & Purna Swaraj (1923–1929)

Following Gandhi's early release on medical grounds in 1924, Indian nationalism entered a phase of internal debate and grassroots reconstruction:

Swarajists vs. No-Changers

A deep tactical divide fractured the Indian National Congress:

- **Swarajists:** Led by **Chitta Ranjan (C.R.) Das** and **Motilal Nehru**, they formed the **Congress-Khilafat Swarajya Party** (1923). They advocated entering the legislative councils under the Government of India Act 1919 to "wreck the reforms from within" through continuous obstruction.
- **No-Changers:** Led by **Vallabhbhai Patel**, **Rajendra Prasad**, and **C. Rajagopalachari**, they opposed council entry and urged full dedication to Gandhi's constructive program—khadi spinning, village sanitation, national education, and anti-untouchability campaigns.

The Simon Commission and the Nehru Report (1927–1928)

In November 1927, the British government appointed an Indian Statutory Commission under Sir John Simon to review the constitutional working of the 1919 Act:

- **The All-White Insult:** The **Simon Commission** did not include a single Indian member. When the commission landed in Bombay in February 1928, it was greeted with black flags, nationwide general strikes, and the thunderous slogan: **"Simon Go Back!"**
- **Lajpat Rai's Martyrdom:** In October 1928, during an anti-Simon protest at Lahore, veteran nationalist **Lala Lajpat Rai** was brutally assaulted in a police lathi charge ordered by British officer James Scott. Lajpat Rai succumbed to his injuries, famously declaring: **"Every blow struck on my chest will be a nail in the coffin of the British Empire."**
- **The Nehru Report (1928):** Drafted by an all-parties committee chaired by Motilal Nehru, it proposed a Dominion Status constitution with joint electorates and fundamental rights, which was rejected by the Muslim League led by M.A. Jinnah (who issued his "Fourteen Points").

The Lahore Congress and the Purna Swaraj Pledge (1929)

In December 1929, the historic annual session of the Congress convened on the banks of the Ravi River in Lahore under the charismatic presidency of the young **Jawaharlal Nehru**:

- **The Purna Swaraj Resolution:** The Congress officially declared its goal to be **Purna Swaraj** (Complete Independence), abandoning the demand for Dominion Status.
- **Unfurling the Flag:** At midnight on **31 December 1929**, Nehru unfurled the newly adopted tricolor national flag of freedom amidst jubilant celebrations.
- **First Independence Day (26 January 1930):** The Congress Working Committee decided that **26 January 1930** would be observed nationwide as **Independence Day**, with millions taking a solemn pledge affirming the inalienable right of the Indian people to overthrow an oppressive colonial regime that had ruined them economically, politically, culturally, and spiritually.

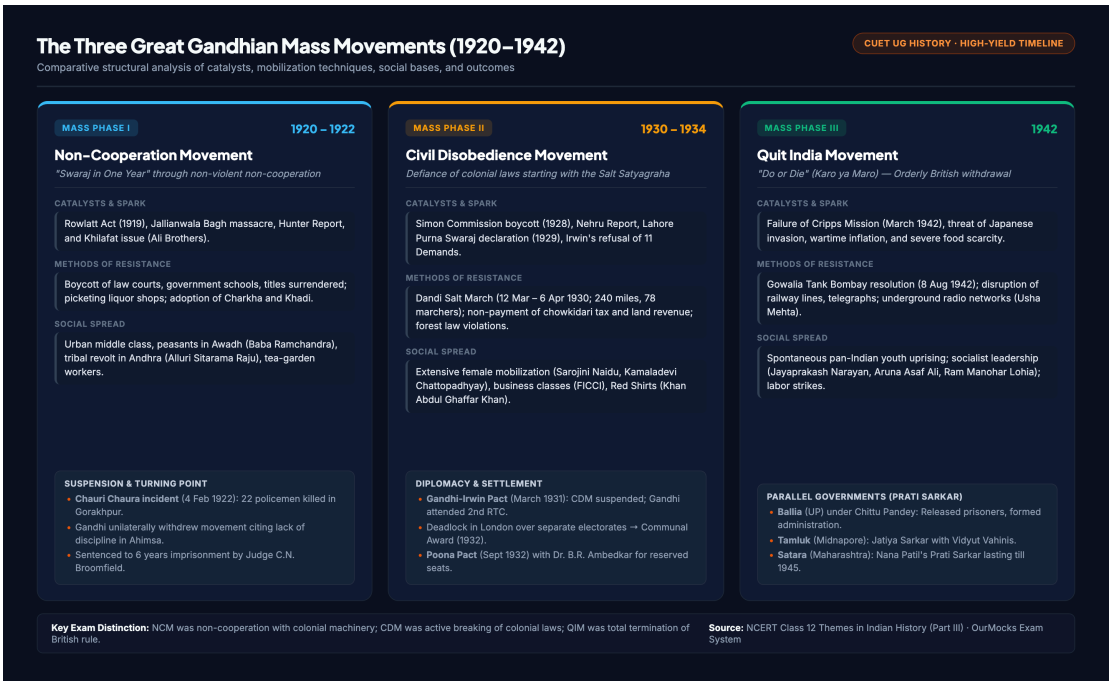


Figure 2: Figure 2 — Chronological Trajectory of Indian National Movements: Sequence of campaigns, constitutional negotiations, mass arrests, and freedom milestones (1915–1948 CE).

5. Civil Disobedience, The Salt March & Constitutional Pacts (1930–1934)

To inaugurate the second great pan-Indian mass movement, Gandhi selected a simple, universal everyday commodity: **salt**:

The Salt Satyagraha and the Dandi March (1930)

Under British law, the colonial state possessed an exclusive monopoly over the manufacture and sale of salt, imposing a regressive excise tax that fell with equal burden upon the poorest peasant and the wealthiest landlord:

- **The Strategic Genius of Salt:** Salt was a universal human necessity, cutting across all caste, religious, and class divides. Gandhi recognized that an assault on the salt monopoly would emotionally unify the entire nation.
- **The March:** On **12 March 1930**, Gandhi departed from the Sabarmati Ashram in Ahmedabad with **78 chosen ashramites** on a 240-mile march to the coastal village of **Dandi** on the Arabian Sea coast of Gujarat.
- **Dandi Defiance (6 April 1930):** Walking 10 miles a day over 24 days, Gandhi reached Dandi on 5 April. On the morning of **6 April 1930**, after ritual morning prayers and a ceremonial sea bath, Gandhi picked up a lump of natural salt mud from the beach, declaring: **"With this, I am shaking the foundations of the British Empire!"**

Pan-Indian Spread of Civil Disobedience

The violation of the salt laws sparked widespread civil disobedience across the country:

- **Tamil Nadu: C. Rajagopalachari** led a salt march from Tiruchirappalli to **Vedaranyam** on the Tanjore coast.
- **Malabar (Kerala): K. Kelappan** marched from Calicut to **Payyanur**.
- **North-West Frontier Province (NWFP): Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan** (popularly known as the **"Frontier Gandhi"**) mobilized the Pathans through his non-violent volunteer

organization, the **Khudai Khidmatgars** ("Servants of God" or "Red Shirts"). When British troops ordered the Garhwal Rifles to fire on an unarmed crowd at Peshawar, the soldiers refused to shoot their fellow countrymen!

- **Dharasana Salt Raid:** In Gujarat, poet **Sarojini Naidu**, accompanied by Gandhi's son Manilal, led 2,500 peaceful satyagrahis to non-violently raid the government Dharasana Salt Works. American journalist **Webb Miller** documented the horrifying brutality of British police, who beat unarmed satyagrahis on their heads with steel-tipped lathis while the victims stoically collapsed without raising a hand to defend themselves. Miller's syndicated reports flashed around the world, turning global public opinion decisively against British rule.

The Round Table Conferences and the Poona Pact

- **The First RTC (1930):** Held in London; boycotted by the Congress; British authorities realized that constitutional settlements were impossible without Congress participation.
- **The Gandhi-Irwin Pact (5 March 1931):** Viceroy Lord Irwin and Gandhi negotiated as diplomatic equals:
  - Congress agreed to suspend Civil Disobedience and participate in the Second RTC.
  - Government agreed to release all non-violent political prisoners, return confiscated lands, and permit coastal villagers to manufacture salt for personal consumption.
- **The Second RTC (London, late 1931):** Gandhi sailed to London as the **sole official representative** of the Congress. The conference collapsed because the British government and sectional leaders (including the Muslim League and Dr. B.R. Ambedkar) prioritized separate communal electorates over national independence. Disillusioned, Gandhi returned to India and resumed Civil Disobedience.
- **The Poona Pact (September 1932):** In August 1932, British Prime Minister Ramsay MacDonald announced the **Communal Award**, which granted **separate electorates** to the "Depressed Classes" (Dalits). Gandhi viewed this as an imperial conspiracy to permanently divide Hindu society. He undertook a **fast unto death** in Yerwada Central Jail in Poona. On **24 September 1932**, Gandhi and Dr. **B.R. Ambedkar** reached an agreement known as the **Poona Pact**: separate electorates were abandoned in exchange for a substantial increase in **reserved seats** (from 71 to 148) in general provincial legislatures.

6. World War II, Cripps Mission & The Quit India Movement (1939–1945)

The outbreak of the Second World War in September 1939 plunged India into an unprecedented political storm:

The Resignation of Congress Ministries (1939)

Without consulting Indian political leaders or the elected provincial legislatures, Viceroy Lord Linlithgow unilaterally declared India to be at war with Nazi Germany. In protest against this imperial autocracy, Congress ministries in all seven provinces resigned en masse in October and November 1939.

The Cripps Mission (March 1942)

Faced with advancing Japanese forces conquering Southeast Asia and threatening India's eastern borders, the British War Cabinet under Winston Churchill dispatched Sir Stafford Cripps to Delhi in March 1942:

- **Cripps' Offer:** Post-war Dominion Status, a constituent assembly, and a clause permitting provinces to secede from the Indian Union.

- **Rejection:** Gandhi dismissed the offer as a **"post-dated cheque on a crashing bank"**, because the British refused to concede immediate transfer of real executive and defense power to Indian hands.

The Quit India Movement (August 1942)

With the failure of the Cripps Mission and the threat of imminent Japanese invasion, Gandhi resolved that only immediate independence could mobilize the Indian people:

- **The Bombay Resolution (8 August 1942):** The All India Congress Committee met at the Gowalia Tank Maidan in Bombay and ratified the historic **Quit India Resolution**.
- **The "Do or Die" Mantra:** Gandhi delivered his electric speech: **"Here is a mantra, a short one, that I give you. The mantra is: 'Do or Die' (Karo ya Maro). We shall either free India or die in the attempt; we shall not live to see the perpetuation of our slavery."**
- **Operation Zero Hour:** Before dawn on **9 August 1942**, British police launched a preemptive strike, arresting Gandhi, Nehru, Patel, Azad, and every major member of the Congress Working Committee under the Defense of India Rules.
- **Spontaneous Mass Upsurge:** Leaderless, the Indian masses rose in an unprecedented insurrection. Young activists, students, and peasants attacked railways, cut telegraph lines, torched police stations, and hoisted the tricolor on government buildings.
- **Underground Networks:** Leaders like **Jayaprakash Narayan**, **Rammanohar Lohia**, **Aruna Asaf Ali**, and **Usha Mehta** operated an underground resistance network. Usha Mehta operated the clandestine **Secret Congress Radio**, broadcasting news of the freedom struggle across western India until she was arrested.
- **Parallel Governments** (Prati Sarkar)**:**
  - **Ballia (UP):** Under Chittu Pandey, rebels took over the district administration for several days.
  - **Tamluk (Midnapore, Bengal):** The **Jatiya Sarkar** established local courts and organized the **Bidyut Bahini** volunteer force.
  - **Satara (Maharashtra):** The longest-lasting parallel government (**Prati Sarkar**), organized by Nana Patil and Y.B. Chavan, established people's courts (**nyaydan mandals**) that functioned until 1944.

7. Partition, Independence, and the Mahatma's Martyrdom (1946–1948)

The post-war period witnessed the tragic confluence of impending freedom and catastrophic communal partition:

The Cabinet Mission and Direct Action Day (1946)

In 1946, the British Labour government sent the **Cabinet Mission** (Pethick-Lawrence, Stafford Cripps, and A.V. Alexander) to formulate a constitutional framework:

- **Three-Tier Confederation:** It proposed a united Indian confederation with three groups of provinces (Group A, B, and C).
- **Breakdown:** Disagreements over provincial grouping led to the breakdown of the plan. On **16 August 1946**, M.A. Jinnah called for **"Direct Action Day"** to enforce the demand for Pakistan. Horrific communal massacres erupted in Calcutta (**The Great Calcutta Killings**), which rapidly spread to Noakhali (East Bengal), Bihar, and the Punjab.

The "One-Man Boundary Force" in Calcutta and Noakhali

While political leaders negotiated in New Delhi, the 77-year-old Mahatma walked barefoot through the violence-ravaged villages of Noakhali and Bihar, staying in Muslim homes and preaching non-violence:

- **15 August 1947:** When India celebrated independence at midnight, Gandhi was not in Delhi to hear Nehru's "Tryst with Destiny" address. He was in riot-torn Calcutta, fasting and spinning yarn at Beliaghata to stop communal bloodletting.
- **Mountbatten's Tribute:** Recognizing that Gandhi had succeeded in maintaining peace where thousands of armed soldiers had failed, Viceroy **Lord Mountbatten** praised him as the **"One-Man Boundary Force"**.

Martyrdom (30 January 1948)

Returning to Delhi in late 1947, Gandhi fasted again to compel the Government of India to honor its financial obligation to transfer Rs 55 crore to Pakistan, and to demand peace for Delhi's Muslim citizens. Hindu extremists condemned his insistence on communal fairness as appeasement:

- **The Assassination:** On the evening of **30 January 1948**, as Gandhi walked to his daily prayer meeting at Birla House in New Delhi, a Hindu fanatic, **Nathuram Godse**, stepped forward, bowed, and shot him three times at point-blank range. As he fell, Gandhi uttered his final words: **"He Ram!"**
- **Nehru's Broadcast:** That night, Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru addressed a grief-stricken nation on All India Radio: **"Friends and comrades, the light has gone out of our lives and there is darkness everywhere... Our beloved leader, Bapu as we called him, the father of the nation, is no more."**

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Chapter Synthesis & Cognitive Mindmap



Figure 3: Figure 3 — Mahatma Gandhi and National Movements Summary Mindmap: Complete synthesis of the South African laboratory, Rowlatt crisis, Non-Cooperation, Dandi March, RTCs, Quit India, and Partition martyrdom.

HIGH-YIELD MEMORY HOOKS & HISTORIOGRAPHICAL POINTERS

- **BHU Speech (Feb 1916):** Gandhi's first major public appearance in India; fiercely condemned elite nationalism and demanded redemption of the peasantry.
- **The Early Triad (1917–1918):** Champaran (indigo, 1st Civil Disobedience) → Ahmedabad (plague bonus, 1st Hunger Strike) → Kheda (revenue remission, 1st Non-Cooperation).
- **Jallianwala Bagh (13 April 1919):** Led to Rabindranath Tagore renouncing his British Knighthood; General Dyer's massacre of hundreds on Baisakhi.
- **Chauri Chaura (4 Feb 1922):** 22 policemen burned inside police station; prompted Gandhi to abruptly withdraw Non-Cooperation via the Bardoli Resolution (12 Feb 1922).
- **Lahore Congress (Dec 1929):** Passed **Purna Swaraj** resolution under Jawaharlal Nehru; declared **26 January 1930** as the First Independence Day.
- **Dandi March (1930):** 12 March to 6 April 1930; 240 miles from Sabarmati to Dandi with 78 ashramites; broke salt law.
- **Poona Pact (Sept 1932):** Signed between Ambedkar and Gandhi; replaced separate electorates for Depressed Classes with reserved seats (increased from 71 to 148).
- **Quit India (8 Aug 1942):** Proclaimed at Gowalia Tank, Bombay; **"Do or Die"**; underground radio run by Usha Mehta; parallel governments in Ballia, Tamluk, and Satara.

MASTER STRATEGY CHEATSHEET — MAHATMA GANDHI & NATIONAL MOVEMENTS

▸**South African Crucible:** Formulated Satyagraha; founded Phoenix Settlement (1904) inspired by Ruskin's **Unto This Last**; returned to India in Jan 1915 on advice of Gokhale. ▸**Non-Cooperation Movement (1920–22):** United with Khilafat; program of title surrender, foreign cloth boycott, and charkha promotion; suspended post-Chauri Chaura (Feb 1922); Broomfield trial. ▸**Lahore Congress (1929):** Declared Purna Swaraj; unfurled tricolor on Ravi river; celebrated First Independence Day on 26 January 1930. ▸**Salt March (1930):** 240-mile march from Sabarmati to Dandi (12 March – 6 April 1930); violated salt monopoly; reported globally by Webb Miller and **Time** magazine; led to Gandhi-Irwin Pact (March 1931). ▸**Poona Pact (1932):** Fast unto death against Ramsay MacDonald's Communal Award; Ambedkar agreed to reserved seats within joint electorates. ▸**Quit India Movement (1942):** Launched post-Cripps failure; "Do or Die" slogan; massive spontaneous sabotage; **Prati Sarkar** at Satara; martyred on 30 Jan 1948 by Godse.

THE SEVEN FATAL CUET TRAPS

1. **Trap 1 (First Indian Public Appearance):** Assuming it was Champaran (1917). Gandhi's first major public appearance was at the **opening of Banaras Hindu University (BHU) in February 1916**.
2. **Trap 2 (Early Satyagraha Order):** Placing Kheda before Ahmedabad. The chronological order is **Champaran (1917) → Ahmedabad (Feb–Mar 1918) → Kheda (Mar–Jun 1918)**.
3. **Trap 3 (Knighthood vs Kaiser-i-Hind):** Confusing awards renounced. **Rabindranath Tagore** renounced his **Knighthood** post-Jallianwala Bagh; **Gandhi** returned his **Kaiser-i-Hind** gold medal in 1920.
4. **Trap 4 (Round Table Attendance):** Assuming Congress attended all RTCs. Congress attended **only the Second RTC (1931)**, where Gandhi was the sole representative.
5. **Trap 5 (Poona Pact Signatories):** Believing Gandhi personally signed the Poona Pact. Gandhi was fasting; **Madan Mohan Malaviya** signed on behalf of caste Hindus, and **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar** signed for the Depressed Classes.
6. **Trap 6 (Independence Day Date in 1930):** Confusing 15 August with 26 January. Under the Lahore Congress resolution, **26 January 1930** was celebrated as the First Independence Day.
7. **Trap 7 (Direct Action Day Catalyst):** Direct Action Day was called on **16 August 1946** by the Muslim League post-Cabinet Mission breakdown, NOT during the 1942 Quit India Movement!

Exam-Style Practice Questions & Detailed Solutions

Part 1: South Africa, Early Satyagrahas & Non-Cooperation (Q1 to Q5)

Q1. At which of the following events did Mahatma Gandhi make his first major public appearance on an Indian political platform after returning from South Africa in 1915?

(A) Champaran Satyagraha inquiry committee meeting (April 1917)
(B) Opening ceremony of the Banaras Hindu University (February 1916)
(C) Lucknow Session of the Indian National Congress (December 1916)
(D) Calcutta Special Session of the Indian National Congress (September 1920)

Sol. Q1. First Major Public Appearance in India:

- Gandhi's first major public appearance occurred in **February 1916** at the opening of the **Banaras Hindu University (BHU)**.
- In his famous address, he rebuked the assembled princes and lawyers for their indifference toward the impoverished peasantry.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Q2. Which philosophical treatise by John Ruskin profoundly transformed Mahatma Gandhi's economic philosophy, leading directly to the founding of Phoenix Settlement in South Africa?

(A) Henry David Thoreau's Civil Disobedience
(B) Karl Marx's Das Kapital
(C) John Ruskin's Unto This Last
(D) Leo Tolstoy's The Kingdom of God Is Within You

Sol. Q2. Influence of Ruskin's Unto This Last:

- Gandhi translated Ruskin's **Unto This Last** as **Sarvodaya** ("Universal Uplift").
- Its thesis—that the good of the individual is contained in the good of all, and that manual labor is the most honorable—inspired Phoenix Settlement (1904).

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q3. What is the correct chronological sequence of the three early local satyagrahas led by Mahatma Gandhi in India between 1917 and 1918?

(A) Champaran Satyagraha → Ahmedabad Mill Strike → Kheda Satyagraha
(B) Ahmedabad Mill Strike → Champaran Satyagraha → Kheda Satyagraha
(C) Kheda Satyagraha → Champaran Satyagraha → Ahmedabad Mill Strike
(D) Champaran Satyagraha → Kheda Satyagraha → Ahmedabad Mill Strike

Sol. Q3. Chronology of Early Satyagrahas:

- **Champaran (1917):** Indigo tinkathia dispute in Bihar.
- **Ahmedabad (Feb–Mar 1918):** Textile mill dispute over plague bonus.
- **Kheda (Mar–Jun 1918):** Peasant crop failure and revenue remission.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q4. In overwhelming anguish and moral protest against the barbaric massacre at Jallianwala Bagh on 13 April 1919, who renounced his British Knighthood?

(A) Mahatma Gandhi
(B) Subhas Chandra Bose
(C) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
(D) Rabindranath Tagore

Sol. Q4. Renunciation of Knighthood by Tagore:

- **Rabindranath Tagore** renounced his British **Knighthood** following the Jallianwala Bagh massacre (13 April 1919).
- Gandhi later returned his **Kaiser-i-Hind** medal during the launch of Non-Cooperation in 1920.

Therefore, Option D is the correct answer. **Answer: (D)**

Q5. Which violent incident in February 1922 compelled Mahatma Gandhi to immediately suspend the nationwide Non-Cooperation Movement through the Bardoli Resolution?

(A) The Chauri Chaura incident
(B) The Kakori train conspiracy
(C) The Jallianwala Bagh massacre
(D) The Chittagong armory raid

Sol. Q5. Chauri Chaura and Suspension of NCM:

- On **4 February 1922**, an enraged crowd set fire to the police station at **Chauri Chaura** (Gorakhpur, UP), killing 22 policemen.
- Gandhi immediately suspended the Non-Cooperation Movement on **12 February 1922** via the Bardoli Resolution.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Part 2: Purna Swaraj, Salt March & The Poona Pact (Q6 to Q10)

Q6. At which historic session of the Indian National Congress was the resolution for 'Purna Swaraj' (Complete Independence) formally adopted under the presidency of Jawaharlal Nehru?

(A) Lahore Session (December 1929)
(B) Calcutta Session (December 1928)
(C) Karachi Session (March 1931)
(D) Nagpur Session (December 1920)

Sol. Q6. The Lahore Congress and Purna Swaraj:

- The **Lahore Congress** of **December 1929**, presided over by **Jawaharlal Nehru**, adopted the **Purna Swaraj** resolution.
- It declared **26 January 1930** as India's First Independence Day.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q7. Which of the following correctly details the exact departure date, duration, and distance covered by Mahatma Gandhi during the historic Salt March from Sabarmati to Dandi?

(A) 6 April to 30 April 1930, covering 150 miles with 50 ashramites
(B) 12 March to 6 April 1930, covering 240 miles with 78 ashramites
(C) 1 January to 26 January 1930, covering 300 miles with 100 ashramites
(D) 8 August to 31 August 1930, covering 200 miles with 72 ashramites

Sol. Q7. Parameters of the Dandi March:

- Gandhi started from Sabarmati Ashram on **12 March 1930** with **78 ashramites**.
- He walked **240 miles** over 24 days, reaching Dandi on 5 April and breaking the salt monopoly on **6 April 1930**.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Q8. Which American journalist provided eyewitness syndicated reports of the brutal police lathi-charge on unarmed satyagrahis at Dharasana Salt Works, swaying global opinion?

(A) Louis Fischer
(B) William Shirer
(C) Webb Miller
(D) Edgar Snow

Sol. Q8. Webb Miller's Reporting:

- **Webb Miller**, an American journalist representing United Press, witnessed the assault on 2,500 peaceful satyagrahis at Dharasana Salt Works in May 1930.
- His graphic dispatches turned international moral opinion decisively against British colonial brutality.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q9. Mahatma Gandhi attended which of the three London Round Table Conferences as the sole official representative of the Indian National Congress?

(A) First Round Table Conference (1930)
(B) Third Round Table Conference (1932)
(C) Joint Parliamentary Conference (1933)
(D) Second Round Table Conference (1931)

Sol. Q9. The Second Round Table Conference:

- Gandhi attended only the **Second Round Table Conference** in London (late 1931) as the **sole representative** of the Congress, following the Gandhi-Irwin Pact.

Therefore, Option D is the correct answer. **Answer: (D)**

Q10. Signed in September 1932 following Gandhi's fast in Yerwada Jail, the historic Poona Pact abandoned separate electorates for Depressed Classes in exchange for:

(A) Immediate adult universal franchise and fifty percent cabinet reservations
(B) An increase in reserved seats within general joint electorates
(C) Separate administrative autonomous provinces for Depressed Classes
(D) The immediate appointment of B.R. Ambedkar to the Viceroy's Executive Council

Sol. Q10. Terms of the Poona Pact:

- The **Poona Pact** (September 1932) abandoned separate electorates for the Depressed Classes in favor of **reserved seats** in joint electorates, increasing seats from 71 to 148.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Part 3: Quit India, Decolonization & Martyrdom (Q11 to Q15)

Q11. On 8 August 1942, at the Gowalia Tank Maidan in Bombay, Mahatma Gandhi proclaimed which historic mantra to inaugurate the Quit India Movement?

(A) 'Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it' (B) 'Inquilab Zindabad'
(C) 'Do or Die' (Karo ya Maro) (D) 'Delhi Chalo'

Sol. Q11. The 'Do or Die' Slogan:

- At the Gowalia Tank Maidan on **8 August 1942**, Gandhi gave the mantra: **"Do or Die"** (**Karo ya Maro**).
- He declared that Indians would either free India or die in the attempt.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**

Q12. During the Quit India Movement of 1942, which district of Maharashtra witnessed the establishment of a long-lasting parallel government ('Prati Sarkar') under Nana Patil?

(A) Satara (B) Ballia
(C) Midnapore (D) Gorakhpur

Sol. Q12. Prati Sarkar at Satara:

- A long-lasting parallel government (**Prati Sarkar**) was established in **Satara** (Maharashtra) under leaders like Nana Patil and Y.B. Chavan, running people's courts until 1944.

Therefore, Option A is the correct answer. **Answer: (A)**

Q13. Which British Viceroy conferred the celebrated tribute on Mahatma Gandhi as a 'One-Man Boundary Force' for maintaining communal peace in riot-torn Bengal in 1947?

(A) Lord Linlithgow (B) Lord Wavell
(C) Lord Irwin (D) Lord Mountbatten

Sol. Q13. The One-Man Boundary Force:

- Viceroy **Lord Mountbatten** praised Gandhi as the **"One-Man Boundary Force"**.
- While 50,000 armed soldiers in Punjab failed to halt communal violence, Gandhi single-handedly restored peace in Bengal through his moral presence and fasting.

Therefore, Option D is the correct answer. **Answer: (D)**

Q14. During the underground phase of the Quit India Movement in 1942, who operated the clandestine 'Secret Congress Radio' that broadcast uncensored news across western India?

(A) Aruna Asaf Ali (B) Usha Mehta
(C) Sucheta Kripalani (D) Sarojini Naidu

Sol. Q14. Usha Mehta and the Underground Radio:

- Dr. **Usha Mehta** operated the clandestine **Secret Congress Radio** during the 1942 movement, broadcasting uncensored messages until she was captured by British police.

Therefore, Option B is the correct answer. **Answer: (B)**

Q15. Following the suspension of the Non-Cooperation Movement in 1922, which British judge presided over Mahatma Gandhi's trial in Ahmedabad, sentencing him to six years' imprisonment?

(A) Judge Sidney Rowlatt (B) Judge John Simon
(C) Judge C.N. Broomfield (D) Judge Reginald Dyer

Sol. Q15. The Broomfield Trial of 1922:

- British Judge **C.N. Broomfield** presided over Gandhi's trial in Ahmedabad in March 1922.
- In his judgment, Broomfield acknowledged Gandhi's immense moral standing while sentencing him to six years' imprisonment.

Therefore, Option C is the correct answer. **Answer: (C)**